The Extended Essay 2027 — Master Checklist

For students starting the DP in August 2025 or later (first assessment May 2027). New criteria: 30 marks, two pathways, one 500-word Reflective Statement.

4,000	30	A–E	~40 hrs	500
word limit — examiners stop reading there	marks · 5 criteria (A6 B6 C6 D8 E4)	grade; with TOK → up to 3 points	of work · 3 supervisor sessions	word Reflective Statement after viva

Non-negotiable: an E in the EE (or TOK) is a diploma failing condition. Word count excludes: title page, contents, tables, equations, referencing footnotes, bibliography, appendices, Reflective Statement.

Pathway & research question

- [ ] Topic comes from genuine interest — it survives 40+ hours
- [ ] Pathway chosen: subject-focused (1 subject) or interdisciplinary (2)
- [ ] I study at least one subject involved; school + supervisor approved
- [ ] Interdisciplinary: framework registered; both subjects do real work
- [ ] RQ is a question, narrow, arguable, answerable with real sources
- [ ] RQ identical on title page, in introduction, in registration

The five interdisciplinary frameworks: power, equality & justice · culture, identity & expression · movement, time & space · evidence, measurement & innovation · sustainability, development & change

A Framework for the essay · 6 marks

Do the RQ, methods and structural conventions provide an effective framework?

- [ ] Focused RQ stated up front — and it never drifts
- [ ] Methods fit the question; I explain *why* I chose them
- [ ] Subject-area structure followed; every section earns its place
- [ ] Title page, contents, page numbers, intro, body, conclusion, bibliography

B Knowledge & understanding · 6 marks

Does the student demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the subject matter?

- [ ] Question placed in the context of the subject
- [ ] Terminology and concepts used accurately, not as decoration
- [ ] Sources relevant and genuinely understood, not just quoted

C Analysis & line of argument · 6 marks

Does the student analyze the information and produce a coherent line of argument?

- [ ] Every source analysed: what it *means for my question*
- [ ] One argument runs start to finish; each paragraph advances it
- [ ] Reasoning between evidence and claim is written out
- [ ] Everything off-question has been cut

D Discussion & evaluation · 8 marks — the biggest

Does the student discuss the findings and evaluate the essay?

- [ ] Balanced discussion, including evidence against my conclusion
- [ ] Limitations of sources, methods and data explicitly evaluated
- [ ] Counter-arguments considered and answered
- [ ] Conclusion answers the RQ, fits the evidence, admits open questions
- [ ] Evaluation woven throughout, not one paragraph at the end

E Reflection · 4 marks

Does the student evaluate the effect of the EE learning experience on them?

- [ ] RRS log kept: two lines after every work session
- [ ] Three sessions done: initial · interim · final (viva voce)
- [ ] Reflective Statement ≤ 500 words, written after the viva
- [ ] It evaluates growth + transferable skills, with specific moments

Formatting & integrity

- [ ] No name, candidate number or school anywhere in the file
- [ ] 12 pt, double-spaced, numbered pages, consistent headings
- [ ] One citation style throughout; bibliography matches the text
- [ ] Tables/graphs titled, labelled, sourced — and discussed
- [ ] Footnotes for referencing only; big data tables → appendix
- [ ] Any AI use cited; every claim checked against real sources

Final submission

- [ ] Word count ≤ 4,000 (correct exclusions), stated on title page
- [ ] Read aloud once, end to end
- [ ] Supervisor's formal draft feedback used; viva voce complete
- [ ] Essay + Reflective Statement submitted early, in the right format